

Request for Proposal

2026 Program Evaluation of the Impact of USW's Support to the Jamaica Baking School in Jamaica and the Infotep Baking School in the Dominican Republic March 30, 2026

Introduction:

U.S. Wheat Associates (USW) requests proposals to conduct a comprehensive program evaluation of USW's long-term support to two regional baking institutions: the Jamaica Baking School in Jamaica and the Infotep Baking School in the Dominican Republic. This evaluation will be conducted through a competitive bidding process and will assess the effectiveness, relevance, and impact of USW's investments in these institutions in improving the quality of wheat-based foods in their respective markets. Evaluation findings will inform strategic decision-making and guide future programming, including recommendations related to training curricula, technical assistance, and potential equipment investments.

USW is a non-profit trade association that develops export markets on behalf of U.S. wheat producers by demonstrating the value of U.S. wheat in over 100 countries through its network of domestic and overseas offices. USW's activities are made possible by producer check-off dollars managed by 19 state wheat commissions and through cost-share funding provided by USDA's Foreign Agricultural Service. More information is available at www.uswheat.org.

Background:

USW has supported the Jamaica Baking School and the Infotep Baking School as part of its broader strategy to enhance technical capacity and improve the quality and consistency of wheat-based food products in the Caribbean region. Support to these institutions has included instructor training, curriculum development, technical courses, baking demonstrations, and, in some cases, provision or facilitation of specialized equipment.

These two institutions serve as key platforms for workforce development and industry training, reaching bakers, food manufacturers, millers, and related professionals. Through these efforts, USW has sought to improve knowledge and application of U.S. wheat, flour functionality, and modern baking techniques, thereby strengthening market demand for U.S. wheat and derivative products.

As USW assesses its long-term programming and future engagement with these schools, an independent evaluation is required to examine outcomes achieved, strengths and weaknesses of past approaches, opportunities for improvement, and alignment with USW's strategic goals.

Scope of Work:

USW seeks a qualified consultancy to design and implement an independent, objective evaluation of USW's support to the Jamaica Baking School and the Infotep Baking School over the past twenty years.

Evaluation Objectives

The evaluation shall:

- Assess the overall effectiveness of USW's efforts to improve the quality of wheat-based foods in Jamaica and the Dominican Republic through training, technical assistance, and institutional support provided to the two baking schools
- Analyze the relevance, sustainability, and impact of USW-supported training and capacity-building activities
- Examine the health and medium and long-term viability of the educational institutions in which these baking schools are housed

- Identify market constraints and opportunities related to wheat-based food production in both countries, as aligned with USW's approved strategic plan
- Provide actionable insights and recommendations to inform future USW programming, including suggested courses, training modalities, and equipment investments

Evaluation Methodology

The evaluation firm will propose and implement an appropriate mixed-methods evaluation approach. This may include, but is not limited to:

- Desk review of relevant USW program documentation, strategic plans, and prior reports
- Informational interviews with USW staff, school administrators, instructors, industry participants, school alumni, and other relevant stakeholders
- Analysis of training reach, outcomes, and contribution to product quality and market development
- Quantitative and qualitative assessment of additional U.S. wheat export sales generated, where applicable, and analysis of U.S. wheat export impact relative to program funding

Deliverables

The primary deliverable will be a **final evaluation report**, including a **formal cover letter**, that addresses each of the following required components:

1. **Executive Summary** addressing USW's assessment of evaluation findings, recommendations, and any resulting changes to program strategy
2. **Evaluation Requirement #1:** Name of the party conducting the evaluation
3. **Evaluation Requirement #2:** Scope of the evaluation
4. **Evaluation Requirement #3:** Concise statement of market constraints, opportunities, and goals as specified in USW's approved strategic plan
5. **Evaluation Requirement #4:** Description of the evaluation methodology
6. **Evaluation Requirement #5:** Description of additional export sales achieved, including the ratio of additional export sales relative to MAP/FMD/RAPP program funding
7. **Evaluation Requirement #6:** Summary of findings and analysis of strengths and weaknesses of the program
8. **Evaluation Requirement #7:** Recommendations for future programs, including guidance on course offerings and equipment support

At the conclusion of the evaluation, the consultant should:

- 1) Provide a written report in English to USW by **October 31, 2026**, that includes all findings and has an executive summary and numbered pages.

ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

The contractor is expected to work closely with the USW team and maintain regular contact throughout the contract period. USW will provide the successful applicant with further information on the context and project objectives. USW will also provide the contractor with information on compliance requirements from the project's funder.

The successful consultant will have:

- A demonstrated knowledge and understanding of program evaluation;
- A demonstrated knowledge and understanding of measuring educational programs and outcomes;
- A demonstrated knowledge and understanding of statistical analysis;
- Demonstrated language capabilities in Spanish and English; and
- Previous experience with studies of this type.

Requested Information:

Please provide the following information regarding your ability to accomplish the tasks and issues previously listed. For comparison purposes, we ask that you include at a minimum the following areas:

- Qualifications and background of your company and individuals assigned to this contract,
- Previous relevant work experience and special expertise,
- Resources available to conduct the scope of work,
- Samples of previous studies, ideally in program evaluation
- A list of references,
- Current or expected conflict of interest,
- Project Cost by Country (Jamaica and the Dominican Republic)

Please provide your project cost on an annual and monthly breakdown for comparison purposes. Please include in your overall cost estimate and break-out the following:

- Expected number of hours dedicated to U.S. Wheat Associates,
- Travel expenses,
 - a. Please note that USW and its consultants must abide by USDA-FAS travel guidelines, including the use of American flag carriers and economy class travel. In addition, lodging and meal expenses will be reimbursed based on the posted per diem rates on the U.S. Department of State Office of Allowances website (https://aoprals.state.gov/web920/per_diem.asp).
- Administrative costs,
- Any third-party fees you may incur to meet the scope of work.

Proposal Deadline:

The project proposal should include further details about the proposed timeline and process based on the scope of work and deliverables described above.

RFP TIMELINE:

- **RFP Distribution:** March 31, 2026
- **A Q&A Session will be held on** Tuesday, April 14 at 11:00 am Mountain Time
 - <https://us06web.zoom.us/j/88445672386?pwd=mpioU6p5xpTt0adgvAeDB7Rlz6bAbD.1>
- **Project Proposals Due:** Tuesday, April 28, 2026, 5:00 pm Mountain Time

Please return your proposal via email in MS Word or Adobe Acrobat format by the close of business on Tuesday, April 28, 2026 to:

Mitchell Skalicky
Regional Vice President
U.S. Wheat Associates
mskalicky@uswheat.org

If you have any questions during the preparation of your proposal, please contact Mitchell Skalicky at the email listed above or Stephanie Bryant-Erdmann at sbe@uswheat.org or +1 402 389 0051.

The successful proposal will be awarded a contract to conduct the study through a letter of agreement that is agreed upon between U.S. Wheat Associates and the consultant.

Confidentiality: Without USW's prior written consent, Prospective Contractors and its officers, employees, agents, representatives, affiliates, and subcontractors shall not disclose to any third party any documents, materials or information that the Prospective Contractors learns from or is provided in relation to the RFP request.